disappointment that the Iranian president had been given "a platform to air his hateful and anti-Semitic views."[40] Those comments, however, had no consequences. They mentioned Iran's antisemitism without discussing it.

Yet another point is remarkable. In his speech, Ahmadinejad followed the *Protocols of the Elders to Zion* almost to the letter. This source, however, which Hitler had used as his textbook for the Holocaust, was—outside of Israel—never publicly identified and the obvious connection between past and present thus denied. In 2008, there was no summoning of Iranian ambassadors. The international media did not even register Ahmadinejad's address as a provocation.

Instead, on the very day of his speech, Ahmadinejad was talkmaster Larry King's guest on CNN where he was offered an hour-long opportunity to hold forth as he pleased, while, two days after his speech, Ahmadinejad, in an interview with the *New York Times,* repeated his antisemitic notions without any challenge from interviewer Neil MacFarquhar. "Zionism," he explained to the readers of the *New York Times*, "is a very secretive political party, which is the root cause of insecurity and wars."[41]

Thus, our two case studies confirm historian Jeffrey Herf's conclusion that "the Islamic Republic of Iran is the first government since Hitler's in which anti-Semitism constitutes a central element of its identity"[42] as well as illustrating the failure of the international community: there has been no adequate response. The inability or unwillingness to recognize the antisemitic character of Tehran's threats has been striking. The Iranian regime was able to continue its offensive not only without punishment but also without suffering isolation. Obviously, Tehran's efforts to blur its antisemitism had been crowned with success.

"IRAN IS OPPOSED TO ANTISEMITISM!"

Just as the Iranian leadership hides its nuclear weapon's research behind a curtain with a "peace" sticker on it, so it hides its antisemitism behind a curtain with the label "anti-Zionism." While the Western powers have remained vigilant in the first case, they have allowed themselves to be fooled in the second.

Immediately after Ahmadinejad's speech of 2005, his predecessor Rafsanjani spoke up and said: "We have no problems with Jews and highly regard Judaism as a religion of the book."[43] Ahmadinejad used the same trick after his UN Speech of 2008: "Zionism is not Judaism," he insisted in his interview with Larry King: "We do not have a problem with the Jewish

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